

MPAS-URBAN QUICKSTART | GUIDE 3 OF 3

Run the HRAIN2025 case

Prepare the run directory, apply the 500 m mesh setting, and optionally use the HRAIN2025 NTDK cutoff modification.

OUTCOME You will launch the three-day HRAIN2025 atmosphere experiment and understand which settings are standard, case-specific, or required only for comparison with existing historical results.

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Before you begin

Complete the recommended official MPAS tutorial and Guides 1–2. Confirm that the initial-condition file and `hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.112` exist.

Choose the executable deliberately: standard `hkust-dev` for normal MPAS-Urban learning and new experiments, or the verified HRAIN2025 case-specific commit

`7c1610b8f41781c2433f780bd7496da63b25a920` for direct historical-result comparison and the optional 10 km CU cutoff. The latter also includes the HRAIN2025 ZT compatibility setting. The pinned derivative remains based on MPAS v8.2.2; its BNU selector was used in Guide 2 while creating the static file and is not a runtime physics switch.

Step 1 | Prepare the run directory

Guide 2 created an independent case under `$HOME/MPAS`. `MPAS_BUILD` is the tutorial-defined path to the compiled MPAS source tree, not an official MPAS variable. Set it again when using a new shell, select the same build used for initialization, and link all runtime files from that build into the existing case.

SELECT THE SAME COMPILED BUILD

```
export MPAS_ROOT="$HOME/MPAS"
export MPAS_BUILD="$MPAS_ROOT/HKUST-MPAS"
```

```
test -x "$MPAS_BUILD/atmosphere_model"
```

For the verified HRAIN2025 comparison/cutoff build, replace `MPAS_BUILD` with `$MPAS_ROOT/HKUST-MPAS-NTDK`. Do not mix files from the two builds.

For direct HRAIN2025 case reproduction, continue from the BNU-generated static and initial-condition files made with that same pinned build. Do not relink a STATSGO-derived case to the cutoff executable.

ENTER THE EXISTING CASE

```
export HRAIN_REPO="$MPAS_ROOT/MPAS-Urban-HRAIN2025"
export CASE="$MPAS_ROOT/HRAIN2025_30km_500m"

test -d "$CASE"
cd "$CASE"
test -s 30km_500m.init.nc
test -s hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.112
```

COPY THE RUN CONFIGURATION

```
cp "$HRAIN_REPO/config/namelist.atmosphere" ./namelist.atmosphere
cp "$MPAS_BUILD/streams.atmosphere" ./streams.atmosphere
```

LINK ALL RUNTIME FILES FROM THE SELECTED BUILD

```
ln -sf "$MPAS_BUILD/atmosphere_model" ./atmosphere_model
ln -sf "$MPAS_BUILD/default_inputs/stream_list.atmosphere.*" .
ln -sf "$MPAS_BUILD/src/core_atmosphere/physics/physics_wrf/files/*TBL" .
ln -sf "$MPAS_BUILD/src/core_atmosphere/physics/physics_wrf/files/*DATA*" .
ln -sf "$MPAS_BUILD/src/core_atmosphere/physics/physics_noahmp/parameters/*TBL" .
```

FINAL FILE CHECK

```
ls -lh atmosphere_model
ls -lh namelist.atmosphere streams.atmosphere
ls -lh 30km_500m.init.nc hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.112
```

BUILD CONSISTENCY NOTE The executable, streams file, stream lists, physics tables, and data links must all come from the same MPAS_BUILD. Do not relink a case after it has produced output; use a separate case directory when comparing source versions.

Step 2 | Set the case time and mesh scale

REFERENCE NAMELIST <https://github.com/Liuzh223/MPAS-Urban-HRAIN2025/blob/main/config/namelist.atmosphere>

FILE TO EDIT namelist.atmosphere. Copy the repository version into the run directory and verify the following fields before launch.

CHANGE 1 - config_start_time: the first model time is 2025-08-03_00:00:00.

CHANGE 2 - config_run_duration: 3_00:00:00 covers the complete three-day case; the commented three-hour value is only a smoke test.

CHANGE 3 - config_dt: 6 seconds is the dynamics time step used by this experiment.

CHANGE 4 - config_len_disp: explicitly set 500.0 here in the running namelist. This is the first point in the tutorial where this case parameter is introduced.

NAMELIST.ATMOSPHERE

```
&nhyd_model
  config_start_time = '2025-08-03_00:00:00'
  config_run_duration = '3_00:00:00'
  config_dt         = 6
  config_len_disp   = 500.0
/
```

REQUIRED CASE SETTING Keep `config_len_disp = 500.0`. It explicitly records the 500 m minimum mesh spacing used by this experiment and should not be omitted even when the mesh contains `nominalMinDc`.

Step 3 | Set the physics schemes and optional cutoff

FILE TO EDIT Continue editing the `&physics` group in `namelist.atmosphere`. The following suite is the explicit HRAIN2025 case configuration; verify every value rather than relying on source-tree defaults.

Physics suite used by HRAIN2025

The case uses WSM6 microphysics, New Tiedtke cumulus, Noah-MP land surface, YSU boundary layer and gravity-wave-drag options, cloud fraction, RRTMG longwave and shortwave radiation, the revised Monin-Obukhov surface layer, and MPAS-Urban. Use the same suite with either source tree; the standard `hkust-dev` build omits `config_cu_disable_dx`.

```
&physics
  config_microp_scheme      = 'mp_wsm6'
  config_convection_scheme  = 'cu_ntiedtke'
  config_lsm_scheme         = 'sf_noahmp'
  config_pbl_scheme         = 'bl_ysu'
  config_gwdo_scheme        = 'bl_ysu_gwdo'
  config_radt_cld_scheme    = 'cld_fraction'
  config_radt_lw_scheme     = 'rrtmg_lw'
  config_radt_sw_scheme     = 'rrtmg_sw'
  config_sfclayer_scheme    = 'sf_monin_obukhov_rev'
  config_urban_physics      = true
/
```

Optional HRAIN2025 cutoff derivative

Use the following only when `atmosphere_model` was compiled from the verified HRAIN2025 case-specific commit `7c1610b8f41781c2433f780bd7496da63b25a920` on `Liuzh223/HKUST-MPAS-LIU` branch `ntdk-grid-cutoff`.

```
&physics
  config_convection_scheme = 'cu_ntiedtke'
  config_cu_disable_dx     = 10000.0
/
```

The value `10000.0` is a 10 km grid-spacing threshold. New Tiedtke convection is disabled where the local mesh spacing is below 10 km. The option default is `0.0`, which leaves the cutoff disabled.

SOURCE NOTE `ntdk-grid-cutoff` is a case-author derivative, not the official HKUST-MPAS main branch. The verified case commit is <https://github.com/Liuzh223/HKUST-MPAS-LIU/commit/7c1610b8f41781c2433f780bd7496da63b25a920>. There is no separate shell command named `cutoff`.

Step 4 | Check the decomposition and streams

CHANGE 1 - namelist.atmosphere/&decomposition: use the prefix `hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.` and launch 112 MPI tasks.

```
&decomposition
  config_block_decomp_file_prefix =
    'hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.'
/
```

Use 112 MPI tasks so that the prefix resolves to `hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.112`. In `streams.atmosphere`, point the input stream to the initial-condition file created in Guide 2 and select the desired output interval.

FILE TO EDIT `streams.atmosphere`. Set the input filename to `30km_500m.init.nc`, choose the history filename and output interval, and verify that all relative paths are resolved from the run directory.

Step 5 | Run and monitor

RUN

```
cd "$CASE"
export OMP_NUM_THREADS=1

mpiexec -n 112 ./atmosphere_model
```

CHECK

```
tail -n 60 log.atmosphere.0000.out
ls -lh history.*.nc 2>/dev/null || ls -lh *.nc
```

For an inexpensive first check, temporarily use a short `config_run_duration`, confirm that output is created, and then restore the intended three-day duration. Do not describe the short smoke test as the HRAIN2025 experiment result.

Final note | Comparing with existing HRAIN2025 results

The HRAIN2025 historical experiment results have not yet been publicly released. This section is needed only for a future direct comparison with those existing results. It is not required for learning MPAS or for a new independent simulation.

Use the verified HRAIN2025 case-specific source commit: <https://github.com/Liuzh223/HKUST-MPAS-LIU/commit/7c1610b8f41781c2433f780bd7496da63b25a920>. This single source contains the 10 km CU cutoff, the HRAIN2025 ZT compatibility setting, and the BNU selector used during static generation; the rainfall branch is not required.

SOURCE FILE

```
src/core_atmosphere/physics/physics_wrf/module_sf_urban.F
```

Inside SFCDFI_URB, the case-specific source has two active ZT updates: one after USTAR is calculated and one inside the stability iteration. The behavior originates from upstream HKUST-MPAS commit 562bdb4e5ef63527496b6374d52def06a01a84a0: <https://github.com/HKUST-MPAS/HKUST-MPAS/commit/562bdb4e5ef63527496b6374d52def06a01a84a0>. Z0 is the momentum roughness length and ZT is the thermal roughness length; this setting does not redefine or recalculate Z0.

$$ZT = 0.1 * Z0$$

The verified case-specific commit already includes both active $ZT = 0.1 * Z0$ assignments, so no manual source edit is needed. Check out the exact commit and rebuild atmosphere_model. Do not confuse this with $ZOHC_TBL = 0.1 * ZOC_TBL$, which is a different calculation.

For a new independent experiment, keep the ZT implementation supplied by the selected HKUST-MPAS version and record the repository, branch, and commit. Do not modify ZT merely to complete the tutorial.

Completion checklist

- config_start_time is 2025-08-03_00:00:00.
- config_run_duration is 3_00:00:00 for the full experiment.
- config_len_disp is explicitly 500.0.
- config_cu_disable_dx is present only for a verified cutoff-capable build and is 10000.0 for this case.
- The MPI task count matches .part.112.
- For direct comparison with existing HRAIN2025 results, use the exact case-specific commit above and a BNU-generated static file; no rainfall-branch checkout or manual source edit is required.

Primary references

- [Official MPAS-A tutorial](#)
- [MPAS-A Quick Start Guide](#)
- [HKUST-MPAS hkust-dev](#)
- [HRAIN2025](#)